

Overview

Document Type: Test Plan

Application: Google Translate – Text Translation

Version: 1.0

Testing Type: Manual Testing

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Testing Scope: Functional, Usability, Performance, Compatibility and Negative Testing

Languages Considered: English, Tamil, Sinhala and other supported languages

Test Environment: Google Translate Web Application – <https://translate.google.com/>

1. Introduction

This test plan defines the approach for manually testing the key features and user flows of Google Translate.

The purpose of the testing is to verify that users can translate content correctly, select and switch languages easily, use translation-related actions, manage their translation history and saved translations, and use the application comfortably across different scenarios.

The testing also focuses on identifying issues that may affect the user experience, such as incorrect or incomplete translations, unexpected behavior with invalid inputs, long text, slow responses, UI problems, and compatibility issues. The testing is mainly based on real user scenarios rather than checking individual UI elements in isolation.

2. Objectives

The main objectives of this testing are to:

- Verify that the core translation functionality works as expected.
- Verify that users can select source and target languages correctly.
- Verify automatic language detection where applicable.
- Verify the language dropdown and search functionality.
- Verify the swap language functionality.
- Verify translation actions such as Listen, Copy, Search with google, Rate and Share.
- Verify text input through typing and pasting.
- Verify behavior with empty, invalid and long inputs.
- Verify History and Saved translation functionality.
- Verify searching, sorting, exporting and deleting saved translations.
- Verify that appropriate messages are displayed when an operation cannot be completed.
- Check translation response time for normal and larger inputs.
- Check usability and consistency of the interface.
- Check the application on different screen sizes and browsers where possible.
- Identify potential functional, usability and performance defects.

3. Scope

3.1 In Scope

The following areas are covered by this test plan:

Translation

- Text translation
- Source language selection
- Target language selection
- Automatic language detection
- Language dropdown
- Language search
- Swap languages
- Typing text
- Pasting text
- Empty input
- Short and long text
- Translation result display

Translation Result Actions

- Listen to translation
- Copy translation
- Google Search
- Rate translation
- Share translation
- Save translation

History

- View translation history
- Open previous translations
- Remove individual history items
- Clear history
- Close history-related actions
- Verify that previously translated content appears correctly

Saved Translations

- Save a translation
- Remove a saved translation
- Star indication
- View saved translations
- Search saved translations
- Sort saved translations
- Clear saved translations
- Export saved translations to Google Sheets

- Verify behavior when a translation is too long to save

Non-Functional Testing

- Usability
- Basic performance
- Compatibility
- Responsive behavior
- Negative testing

3.2 Out of Scope

The following are not the main focus of this testing:

- Testing Google's internal translation engine or machine-learning model.
- Verifying every supported language individually.
- Testing Google's backend infrastructure.
- Security penetration testing.
- Source-code-level testing.
- Automated testing.
- Detailed accessibility compliance testing unless a specific issue is identified during manual testing.

Translation accuracy will be checked from a practical user perspective. It is not possible to determine linguistic correctness for every supported language combination without native-language expertise.

4. Test Approach

The testing will follow a risk-based manual testing approach.

Priority will be given to the flows that are most important to a normal user:

1. Enter text.
2. Select or detect the source language.
3. Select the target language.
4. Translate the content.
5. Verify the result is displayed.
6. Use the available result actions.
7. Save or access the translation later through History/Saved.
8. Validate behavior for invalid, empty and large inputs.

After the main flow is verified, additional exploratory testing will be performed to identify unexpected behavior.

The testing will cover both:

- **Positive scenarios** – where valid input and expected user actions are provided.
- **Negative scenarios** – where empty, unsupported, excessive or unexpected input/actions are used.

5. Functional Test Areas

5.1 Language Selection

The language selection functionality will be tested to ensure users can easily select the required source and target languages.

Scenarios

- Open the source language dropdown.
- Verify available languages are displayed.
- Search for a language.
- Select English.
- Select Tamil.
- Select Sinhala.
- Select another supported language such as Spanish.
- Search using the full language name.
- Search using partial text.
- Search for a language that does not exist.
- Change the selected language after entering text.
- Verify the selected language remains displayed correctly.

5.2 Automatic Language Detection

Scenarios

- Enter English text and verify English is detected where applicable.
- Enter Tamil text and verify Tamil detection.
- Enter Sinhala text and verify Sinhala detection.
- Enter mixed-language content.
- Enter numbers only.
- Enter special characters only.
- Enter a very short input where language detection may be difficult.
- Change the detected language manually.

The objective is not only to verify detection but also to ensure that the user can manually correct the detected language when required.

5.3 Swap Languages

Scenarios

- Select English → Tamil and click Swap.
- Verify it changes to Tamil → English.
- Verify the existing input/result relationship is updated correctly.
- Repeat with Sinhala and another language.
- Try swapping before entering text.
- Try swapping after entering text.
- Verify that the swap icon is clearly visible and usable.

5.4 Text Input

Positive Scenarios

- Enter a short sentence.
- Enter multiple sentences.
- Enter a paragraph.
- Paste text into the input field.
- Enter text containing punctuation.
- Enter numbers.
- Enter dates.
- Enter special characters.
- Enter mixed English/Tamil/Sinhala content.

Negative Scenarios

- Leave the input empty.
- Enter only spaces.
- Enter only special characters.
- Enter a very large amount of text.
- Paste unsupported/unusual characters.
- Paste content containing multiple languages.

6. Translation Result Testing

The translation result should be displayed after valid input is submitted.

Scenarios

- Verify translation is generated.
- Verify the output language matches the selected target language.
- Verify output is not unnecessarily reduced.
- Verify punctuation is handled reasonably.
- Verify line breaks are displayed properly.
- Verify longer translations remain usable.
- Change the source/target language and verify the result updates.
- Enter new text and verify the previous result does not remain incorrect.

Practical Accuracy Check

For selected English → Tamil and English → Sinhala scenarios, the translated result will be reviewed for:

- General meaning
- Missing words
- Unexpected words
- Clearly incorrect translations
- Untranslated English terms
- Contextually unsuitable wording
- Sentence structure

- Obvious grammar issues

Translation accuracy findings will be documented carefully because a translation can be technically understandable while still being unnatural or contextually inappropriate.

7. Translation Result Actions

The following actions will be tested individually.

Listen

- Click Listen.
- Verify the translation is read aloud.
- Verify the correct language/pronunciation is used where possible.
- Check behavior when there is no translation.

Copy

- Click Copy.
- Paste the result somewhere else.
- Verify the copied content matches the displayed translation.

Google Search

- Click Search.
- Verify the expected search behavior.
- Verify the selected content is passed correctly.

Share

- Click Share.
- Verify the share functionality opens correctly.
- Verify the relevant translation/content is shared.

Rate

- Verify rating options are available.
- Submit a rating.
- Verify the interaction completes without an error.

Save

- Click the star/save icon.
- Verify the translation is saved.
- Verify the star visually changes to indicate the saved state.
- Remove it from saved items.
- Verify the star returns to its normal state.

8. History Testing

History is an important area because users expect previous translations to remain available.

Test Scenarios

- Perform a translation.
- Open History.
- Verify the translation appears.
- Open a previous translation.
- Verify source and target languages.
- Verify the translated content.
- Use the three-dot menu for a history item.
- Verify the option to remove the item is displayed.
- Remove one history item.
- Verify only the selected item is removed.
- Clear all history.
- Verify the history becomes empty.
- Close the clear-history action.
- Verify history remains unchanged after close.

Relationship Between History and Saved Translations

A translation that is saved should also show the appropriate saved state when viewed through History.

The star should be visibly highlighted when the translation is saved.

If the translation is not saved, the star should not appear highlighted.

9. Saved/Favorite Translation Testing

Save Flow

1. Perform a translation.
2. Click the star icon.
3. Verify the translation is added to the Saved section.
4. Verify the star is highlighted.
5. Open the Saved section.
6. Verify the translation is available.

Remove Flow

1. Open a saved translation.
2. Click the highlighted star.
3. Verify it is removed from saved translations.
4. Verify the star is no longer highlighted.

Search

- Search for an existing saved translation.
- Search using partial text.
- Search using text that does not exist.
- Clear the search.
- Verify the complete saved list returns.

Sorting

Test sorting:

- By date
- Alphabetically

Verify that the displayed order changes correctly and that no saved translation is lost.

Clear Saved Translations

- Select the clear option.
- Verify confirmation behavior.
- Cancel the action.
- Confirm that saved items remain.
- Confirm the action.
- Verify saved translations are removed.

Export

- Select the export option.
- Verify the export process starts.
- Verify the correct saved translations are included.
- Verify the exported information is usable in Google Sheets.

10. Long Text Testing

Long input is treated as an important boundary scenario.

Scenarios

- Enter a normal paragraph.
- Enter a large paragraph.
- Enter text close to the supported limit.
- Enter text beyond the expected limit.
- Verify whether translation is generated.
- Verify whether the UI remains responsive.
- Verify whether the result is fully accessible.
- Attempt to save a very long translation.

11. Performance Testing

This is basic manual performance testing rather than formal load testing.

Areas to Observe

- Initial page loading time
- Time taken to display a translation
- Response after changing languages
- Response after clicking Translate-related actions
- History loading time
- Saved translations loading time
- Search response
- Export response

12. Usability Testing

The application should be tested from the perspective of a normal user.

Areas to Check

- Are the main controls easy to find?
- Are language dropdowns understandable?
- Is the Swap option obvious?
- Is the input area clear?
- Is the translated result easy to read?
- Are icons understandable?
- Is the Save state visually clear?
- Are errors and informational messages understandable?
- Is History easy to access?
- Can users easily remove individual history items?
- Is it clear when a translation has been saved?
- Are confirmation dialogs understandable?
- Can the user cancel an operation without accidentally losing data?

13. Compatibility Testing

Where test environments are available, the following should be checked:

Browsers

- Google Chrome
- Microsoft Edge
- Mozilla Firefox

Screen Sizes

- Desktop

- Laptop
- Tablet
- Mobile/responsive view

Compatibility Scenarios

- Verify language dropdowns work.
- Verify translation results are displayed correctly.
- Verify icons are visible.
- Verify History opens correctly.
- Verify Saved section works.
- Verify text does not overlap.
- Verify dialogs are usable.
- Verify long translation content does not break the layout.

14. Negative Testing

Negative testing will be performed to check how the application behaves when users provide unexpected input or perform unusual actions.

Examples include:

Scenario	Expected Behavior
Empty input	No incorrect translation should be generated
Spaces only	Application should handle the input gracefully
Special characters only	Application should not crash
Numbers only	Application should handle the input correctly
Very long input	Appropriate handling/message should be provided
Unsupported search language	No-result state should be clear
Delete history and cancel	Existing history should remain
Remove unsaved translation	Appropriate state should remain
Save overly long translation	Appropriate message should be displayed
Multiple rapid actions	UI should remain stable
Change language after translation	Result should update correctly

15. Exploratory Testing

After executing the planned scenarios, exploratory testing should be performed.

The tester should follow realistic user behavior rather than only executing predefined steps.

For example:

Scenario:

1. Select English → Tamil.
2. Enter a paragraph.
3. Translate it.
4. Listen to the result.
5. Copy the result.
6. Save it.
7. Open History.
8. Verify the saved state.
9. Remove the history item.
10. Check whether the saved translation is still available.
11. Remove the saved translation.
12. Translate another sentence.
13. Change the language.
14. Swap languages.
15. Repeat the translation.

This type of flow can reveal state-management issues that individual test cases may not identify.

16. Potential Defect Areas

During testing, particular attention should be given to the following areas:

Functional

- Translation not generated
- Incorrect source/target language
- Swap not working correctly
- Save state not updated
- History not updated
- Deleted items still appearing
- Export missing records
- Search returning incorrect results

UI/Usability

- Misaligned controls
- Unclear messages
- Incorrect icon state
- Truncated content
- Overlapping elements

- Poor responsive behavior

Data/State

- Saved translation disappears unexpectedly
- History and Saved state are inconsistent
- Removing from History incorrectly removes Saved translation
- Star state does not match Saved state

Performance

- Translation takes unusually long
- History takes too long to load
- Search becomes slow with many saved items
- UI becomes unresponsive during processing

Translation Quality

Potential issues may include:

- Meaning changed
- Missing content
- Unnecessary words
- Incorrect context
- Untranslated words
- Awkward sentence construction

Translation-quality findings should be reported with the original text, translated text, expected meaning, and language pair so that the issue can be reviewed properly.

17. Test Data

The following test data should be prepared:

Basic

- English sentences
- Tamil sentences
- Sinhala sentences
- Mixed-language sentences

Text Types

- Short sentence
- Multiple sentences
- Paragraph
- Long paragraph
- Numbers
- Dates

- Currency values
- Special characters
- Punctuation
- Names
- Technical terms

Examples of Language Pairs

- English → Tamil
- Tamil → English
- English → Sinhala
- Sinhala → English
- English → Spanish

Additional supported languages can be selected during exploratory testing.

18. Entry Criteria

Testing can begin when:

- The application is accessible.
- The main translation functionality is available.
- Required test browsers/devices are available.
- Test data is prepared.
- The tester has access to History and Saved features.
- The expected behavior of major features is available or can be reasonably validated from the product.

19. Exit Criteria

Testing can be considered complete when:

- Major translation flows have been tested.
- Critical and high-priority functional scenarios are completed.
- History and Saved functionality have been tested.
- Negative scenarios have been covered.
- Basic performance observations have been recorded.
- Compatibility checks have been completed for the available environments.
- Identified defects have been documented.
- Test results and observations have been summarized.

Testing should not be considered complete simply because all test cases are executed. Any unresolved critical issues should be highlighted before providing the final test summary.

20. Defect Reporting Approach

For each confirmed defect, the following information should be recorded:

- Defect ID
- Summary
- Environment
- Preconditions
- Steps to reproduce
- Test data
- Expected result
- Actual result
- Severity
- Priority
- Evidence/screenshot
- Reproducibility
- Status

21. Severity Guidelines

Severity	Description
Critical	Major functionality is completely unavailable or application cannot be used
High	Important functionality is significantly affected
Medium	Functionality works but has a noticeable issue
Low	Minor UI, wording or cosmetic issue

Severity should be assigned based on the actual impact rather than simply how visible the issue is.

22. Risks and Considerations

Translation Accuracy

Because Google Translate supports a large number of languages, manual verification of every translation is not practical.

For selected languages, the tester can validate whether the translated meaning is reasonable. Native-language review may be required for definitive linguistic validation.

Dynamic Behavior

Translation results can change because the underlying translation service may be updated independently of the UI.

External Dependencies

Features such as sharing, Google Search, Google Sheets export and voice-related functionality may depend on browser permissions, account state or external services.

Network Conditions

Translation response time can vary depending on network conditions. Performance observations should therefore be recorded with the test environment and network conditions.

23. Deliverables

The testing activity should produce:

1. Test Plan
2. Test Cases
3. Test Execution Results
4. Defect/Bug Report
5. Test Summary Report
6. Screenshots or other supporting evidence for relevant findings

24. Overall Test Strategy

The overall strategy is to validate Google Translate from both a **feature perspective and a real user's perspective**.

The core translation flow will be tested first, followed by supporting features such as Save, History, Search, Sort and Export. Negative and boundary scenarios will then be used to identify unexpected behavior.

Special attention will be given to the relationship between **translation results, History and Saved translations**, because these features depend on maintaining the correct state across different parts of the application.

The testing will also consider usability and practical performance rather than focusing only on whether a button technically works.

The final assessment will be based on the actual execution results and confirmed defects rather than assumptions about how the application should behave.